Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥10

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥2

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥2

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 9 6 5
♥ A Q 9 3
♦ K Q 8
♣ A 6

♠ 8 7
♥ 6 4 2
♦ J 7 5
♣ Q J 9 5 3



♠ A 4 2
♥ J 10 8 7
♦ 10 6 4 2
♣ K 10

♠ K J 10 3
♥ K 5
♦ A 9 3
♣ 8 7 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥J

SOUTH uses Stayman because he has a 4-card ♠ suit.

NORTH's 2♥ response wasn't exactly what SOUTH was hoping for, so SOUTH decides to bid 3NT.

NORTH absolutely knows that SOUTH holds a 4-card Major - and also knows that it isn't ♥s. So NORTH bids 4♠.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K 3 2
♥ J 9 5 3
♦ J
♣ A J 6 3 2

♠ J 9 7 4
♥ Q 8 6 2
♦ 10 8 7 6
♣ 4



♠ A 10 6
♥ A K 7 4
♦ A Q 5 3
♣ 10 9

♠ Q 8 5
♥ 10
♦ K 9 4 2
♣ K Q 8 7 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♥	
All Pass			

2♥ by East
Lead: ♥10

WEST has a rotten hand, and many players would just pass 1NT.

But WEST figures that having EAST play any 4-4 fit would be better than 1NT so he bids 2♣, Stayman. This is called "Garbage Stayman", and you can see why.

EAST bids 2♥ and WEST passes. He would have passed either 2♠ or 2♦ also.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K J 7 3 ♥ Q 9 5 ♦ K 10 4 ♣ Q 9 3	
♠ 10 9 5 ♥ A 7 3 2 ♦ J 8 7 5 ♣ J 10	N W E S	♠ 8 4 ♥ 10 6 4 ♦ Q 9 3 ♣ A 6 5 4 2
	♠ A Q 6 2 ♥ K J 8 ♦ A 6 2 ♣ K 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♥2

Just having a 4-card Major doesn't mean you must automatically use Stayman.

Here NORTH has a 4-card ♠ suit, but decides not to seek a 4-4 fit because his hand wouldn't have any ruffing values in a ♠ contract. He bids 3NT.

Notice that even though SOUTH also has four ♠s the 4-4 fit is not useful to them in a ♠ contract because neither hand can ruff any losers.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 5 3 ♥ 10 8 2 ♦ 9 5 2 ♣ K J 9 7 2	
♠ K J 7 ♥ K J 5 4 ♦ K Q 7 3 ♣ A 5		♠ Q 10 8 6 4 ♥ Q 7 3 ♦ A 6 ♣ 10 8 4
	♠ A 9 2 ♥ A 9 6 ♦ J 10 8 4 ♣ Q 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥2

EAST has an invitational (9 point) hand with five ♠s.

She bids it in the standard way - first transfer WEST to ♠s, then invite the game by bidding 2NT.

WEST, with 17 points and three ♠s, accepts the game invitation and chooses 4♠.